CHAPTER 9

RBI MATTERS

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Perhaps the most energizing aspect of my term at the Reserve Bank was the opportunity to work with some of the most dedicated professionals I have met in my life, the staff of the Reserve Bank. The average quality of people was high by even international standards, let alone public sector standards, the organization took pride in its work, and it had a great tradition of comradery and community. The younger staff of the RBI were from a broad variety of schools and backgrounds, truly representative of Indian diversity. They were enthusiastic, and eager to work and learn. I soon realized that when I set a group a task, they would invariably rise to the occasion and produce high quality work. On the 80 anniversary of the RBI on 1 April 2015, this is the message I sent my colleagues.

Remarks on RBI's 80th Anniversary

The Reserve Bank of India is eighty years old today. Eighty years is a long time in the life of a human, one which people in the south celebrate with a Sathabhishekham, but it is not a long time in the life of an institution. Nevertheless much has happened since the year 1935 when the Reserve Bank was set up to 'regulate the issue of Bank notes and the keeping of reserves with the view to securing monetary stability in India and generally to operate the currency and credit system of the country to its advantage'.